



BUSINESS ANALYSIS

Ethics & Professional Practice

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ETHICAL DECISION MAKING

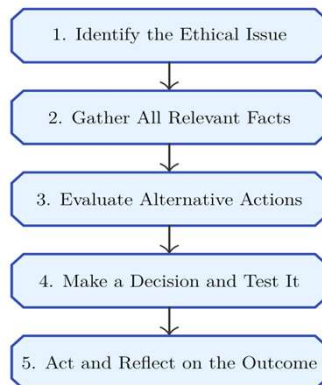
- **What are ethical considerations in business analysis?** “The moral principles and values that guide the conduct of a business analyst in their professional practice.” These considerations encompass aspects such as
 - Honesty,
 - Confidentiality,
 - Objectivity,
 - Respect for diversity.
- **Why are ethical considerations important:**
 - To maintain trust and credibility and build a strong relationship with stakeholders
 - To foster a culture of honesty and transparency and uphold the reputation of an organization
 - To avoid conflict of interest
 - To ensure protection of sensitive information
 - To promote fairness and equality in decision making

Source: iCertGlobal; <https://www.icertglobal.com/blog/ethical-considerations-in-business-analysis>

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HOW TO IMPLEMENT ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN BUSINESS



- **Establish a Code of Ethics:** The code outlines the ethical principles and guidelines that all analysts must adhere to e.g., confidentiality, conflict of interest, and professional conduct.
- **Conduct Ethical Training:** Provide training to enhance understanding of ethical considerations e.g., through case studies, role-playing scenarios, and ethical dilemmas to help analysts navigate complex situations.
- **Promote Open Communication:** Encourage open and honest communication within the organization to address ethical concerns and dilemmas; create channels for employees to report unethical behavior or breaches of conduct without fear of retaliation.
- **Seek Feedback and Review:** Regularly seek feedback from stakeholders and conduct reviews of the analysis process to identify any ethical issues or concerns. Use this feedback to improve processes and procedures to ensure ethical behavior is maintained."

Source: keepnet; <https://keepnetlabs.com/blog/privacy-is-important-for-your-business>
 Business Analysis Essentials; <https://ofoe.com/learn/mba-business-analysis-essentials-j0vb8r/ethics-and-professionalism-in-business-analysis-7>

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PRIVACY

- Privacy in business involves protecting sensitive information, such as customer data, from unauthorized access or misuse.
 - Ensures customer trust
 - Protects companies from legal issues, and resultant financial losses
 - Protects companies from reputational damage.
- Examples of issues resulting from privacy breach.
 - In 2023, the global average cost of a data breach reached \$4.45 million, a 15% increase over three years, highlighting the growing financial burden on organizations.
 - A 2024 report by Fortinet revealed that nearly three-fourths of operational technology professionals experienced intrusions impacting operational technology systems, up from 49% in 2023, indicating a significant rise in operational disruptions due to cyber incidents.
 - In July 2024, a faulty update by cybersecurity firm CrowdStrike led to a global outage affecting 8.5 million devices, causing substantial disruptions across various sectors and resulting in significant reputational damage for the company.

Source: keepnet; <https://keepnetlabs.com/blog/privacy-is-important-for-your-business>

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BIAS

- Bias can be usefully defined as 'a systematic deviation from rational judgement that affects decision making and problem-solving.
 - Influences thoughts, decisions, and how one interacts
 - Interferes with efforts aimed at designing solutions to real, complex problems
- How bias creeps into business analysis:
 - Bias in requirements elicitation: bias can easily influence requirements elicitation, particularly in high pressure environments. For example, the loudest voice in the room or the highest-paid person's option (HiPPO) often dominates.
 - Bias from stakeholder relationships: bias also emerges during workshops. A BA may favour technical stakeholders they know well, giving their views more weight.
 - Bias from past experience: when working in a familiar industry, a BA might assume they already understand the problem. Instead of conducting fresh discovery sessions, they rely on previous solutions.
 - Bias in choosing tools and methods: Sometimes BAs commit to tools or techniques prematurely, before fully understanding the problem.

Source: bcs; <https://www.bcs.org/articles-opinion-and-research/bias-in-business-analysis/>

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UNDERSTANDING & DEALING WITH HOW THE BRAIN GENERATES BIAS

- Checking our thought process: kinds of biases to watch for:
 - Confirmation bias: favoring evidence that supports existing beliefs
 - Anchoring bias: over-relying on the first pieces of information received
 - Availability bias: giving undue weight to recent or memorable data
 - Groupthink: Prioritising consensus over critical thinking
- How can a BA reduce bias:
 - Using structured frameworks to test assumptions
 - Involving diverse stakeholders from the outset
 - Applying critical thinking and peer review
 - Revisiting solutions post-implementation to reflect and adjust

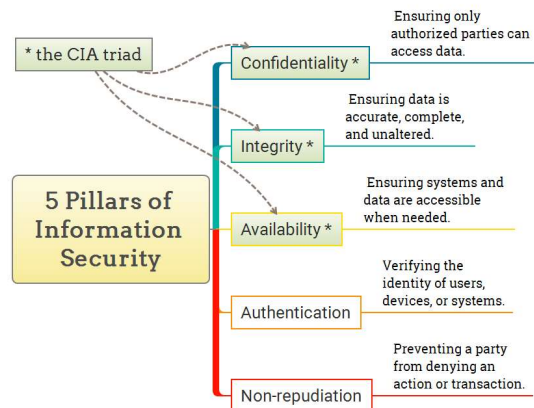
Source: bcs; <https://www.bcs.org/articles-opinion-and-research/bias-in-business-analysis/>

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SECURITY CONCERNS FOR BUSINESS ANALYSTS

5 Pillars of Information Security



Source: Medium; <https://mappedarch.medium.com/confidentiality-integrity-availability-authentication-non-repudiation-d2f4eb2f8c28>
splunk; https://www.splunk.com/en_us/blog/learn/cia-triad-confidentiality-integrity-availability.html

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SECURITY OPTIONS

TYPE	WHAT IS AT RISK	SECURITY OPTION
Information Security	Data & information	Encryption, firewalls
Network Security	Computer networks	VPNs, IDS, firewalls
Cybersecurity	Digital systems	Malware protection, secure coding
Operational Security	Operations/processes	Secure protocols, risk assessment

Source: filo; <https://askfilo.com/user-question-answers-smart-solutions/types-of-security-3433373936393135>

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PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT IN BUSINESS ANALYSIS

- Why is ethical and professional conduct essential for a business analyst:
 - A BA translates needs into solutions, influences decisions, and handles sensitive information
 - Credibility of a BA hinges on his integrity; stakeholders trust that a BA will have the best interest of the organization in mind
 - The analysis and recommendations of a BA carry immense weight and can determine whether business strategy fails or succeeds.
- Core professional principles:
 - Integrity: Be honest and straightforward in all professional relationships.
 - Objectivity: Avoid bias, conflicts of interest, or undue influence from others.
 - Confidentiality: Respect the privacy of information acquired and do not disclose it without proper authority.
 - Competence: Maintain professional knowledge and skill at the level required to ensure competent service

Source: Business Analysis Essentials; <https://oboe.com/learn/mba-business-analysis-essentials-j0vb8r/ethics-and-professionalism-in-business-analysis-7>

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PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT IN BUSINESS ANALYSIS

- Professional conduct at a workplace encapsulates the behaviors, attitudes, and ethics that characterize a professional persona; it isn't confined to the attire you wear but extends to
 - Integrity,
 - Respect for colleagues and company norms, and
 - Consistent reliability.
- How professional conduct influences career:
 - Build a Professional Image: Create image as a capable and reliable employee.
 - Foster Workplace Culture: Create a positive & productive environment; workers prefer companies that prioritize employee well-being.
 - Navigate Career Opportunities: Your adaptability and commitment to quality opens career and promotion opportunities

Source: vcomply; <https://www.v-comply.com/blog/professional-conduct-in-the-workplace-tips/#:~:text=Professional%20conduct%20in%20the%20workplace%20encapsulates%20the%20behaviors%2C%20attitudes%2C%20and%20company%20norms%2C%20and%20consistent%20reliability.>

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INDICATORS OF A PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

- **“Respect and Courtesy:** Treating colleagues and clients with respect, fostering a positive workplace atmosphere.
- **Integrity and Competence:** Conducting oneself honestly and skillfully, maintaining ethical standards.
- **Appropriate Dress:** Wearing attire that suits the professional setting and role.
- **Effective Communication:** Sharing information clearly and thoughtfully, whether in writing or verbally.
- **Consistency under Pressure:** Remaining productive and focused, even in stressful or challenging situations.”

Source: vcomply; <https://www.v-comply.com/blog/professional-conduct-in-the-workplace-tips/#:::text=Professional%20conduct%20in%20the%20workplace%20encapsulates%20the%20behaviors%2C%20attitudes%2C%20and,company%20norms%2C%20and%20consistent%20reliability.>

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ESSENTIAL READINGS

bcs: “Bias in business analysis”, available at <https://www.bcs.org/articles-opinion-and-research/bias-in-business-analysis/>

filo: “Types of security”, available at <https://askfilo.com/user-question-answers-smart-solutions/types-of-security-3433373936393135>

Business Analysis Essentials: “Introduction to business analysis”, available at <https://oboe.com/learn/mba-business-analysis-essentials-j0vb8r/ethics-and-professionalism-in-business-analysis-7>

iCertGlobal: “Ethical considerations in business analysis”, available at <https://www.icertglobal.com/blog/ethical-considerations-in-business-analysis>

keepnet: “What is privacy in business”, available at <https://keepnetlabs.com/blog/privacy-is-important-for-your-business>

splunk: “What is the CIA Triad,” available at https://www.splunk.com/en_us/blog/learn/cia-triad-confidentiality-integrity-availability.html

vcomply: “Essential ways to practice professional conduct in the workplace,” available at [Link](#)

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REFERENCE BOOKS OPTIONS

- **BUSINESS ANALYSIS BODY OF KNOWLEDGE (BABOK)**; IIBA Bookstore: <https://www.iiba.org/career-resources/a-business-analysis-professionals-foundation-for-success/babok/>
- **BUSINESS ANALYSIS (Fourth Edition)** by Debra Paul (Author), James Cadle (Author), Malcolm Eva (Author), Craig Rollason (Author), Jonathan Hunsley (Author)
- **BUSINESS ANALYSIS TECHNIQUES: 123 ESSENTIAL TOOLS FOR SUCCESS (3RD Edition)** by James Cadle (Author), Debra Paul (Author), Jonathan Hunsley (Author), Adrian Reed (Author)